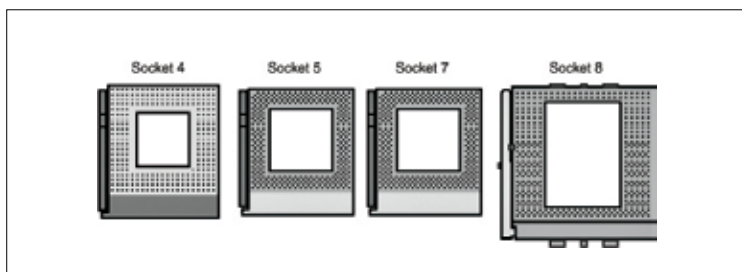


The heatsink is generally made of a cheap metal that exhibits high thermal conductivity. Aluminium and copper are the current favourites. Heat pipes made out of copper generally act as a conduit to draw heat away from the source and towards the cooling mechanism i.e. the fans. Some times, there will be a vapour chamber instead of the heatpipes. Then there are coolers with both heatpipes and vapour chambers. The efficacy of each approach is not a simple matter of figuring out what technology is used. There are a lot more intricacies including the heatsink, cooler and vapour chamber metrics. The combination of all parameters surrounding these three components makes your average cooler, not so average in terms of the complexity that comes with it.

Things to consider before getting your cooler

Socket compatibility: The first thing to consider should be socket compatibility. Cooler manufacturers will mostly list down all the supported sockets on the product page of the cooler itself. There are times when there are universal mounts for both AMD and Intel processors. However, it's a good practice to always check for official support. In liquid cooling systems, you need to check for the CPU block's compatibility. The same goes for graphics cards when you're buying custom liquid cooling kits. Universal GPU blocks will be able to cool your GPU but might cover the VRM and memory. Since the design is different among manufacturers, the cooling kit manufacturer will list down all the supported graphics card variants from every manufacturer. If you can't find your variant's GPU block, chances are that they don't support your graphics card.

Case compatibility: Aside from socket compatibility, you should definitely check if your existing case can fit the cooler you're considering for purchase. Buying a liquid cooler AIO with a 360 mm radiator for a mini-ITX



Coolers generally support multiple sockets.